reported that they had seen large concentrations of tribal Afghans or *Kabailis* in the area around Abbottabad and Man Shera. The air was rife with rumours that they were a part of an invasion plan of the Kashmir Valley. On Mahajan informing him of this development, the Maharaja cabled Attlee but there was no reaction of consequence. The Maharaja followed this missive with another written communication on 18 October 1947, this time to Pakistan's Governor General Jinnah and Prime Minister Liaquat Ali Khan with information about border incursions, subversion of Muslim troops in the state's forces and the other violations of the standstill agreement.

On 18 October 1947, British officers and bureaucrats, holidaying with their families in the valley, were given emergency evacuation orders.[9] The very next day, on 19 October 1947, 20 RAF buses and trucks from Rawalpindi and Peshawar carried these passengers away from Srinagar to Rawalpindi via Baramulla, Uri and Muzaffarabad. The Maharaja himself was surprised and offended by this unexplained exodus. Clearly, an invasion was imminent. However, the Maharaja was unable to be decisive. To make matters worse, the same day, Liaquat Ali Khan wrote to Mahajan admonishing the state for trampling on the rights of the state's Muslim majority. This was followed by Jinnah's letter to the Maharaja on 20 October 1947, proposing an end to the acrimony and inviting the Maharaja to send Mahajan to Lahore for amicable talks that aimed to settle matters. The Maharaja declined. The following day, the Maharaja and Mahajan made a flash tour of Mirpur district to assess the extent of infiltration along the borders, following the fall of Fort Owen.

In the light of these fast-moving developments in the state, it seems incredible that Defence Minister, Sardar Baldev Singh not only discounted Maj. Kalkat's accounts but also chose to bury his head in the sand. The extent of British perfidy and complicity in a grand overall plan to annex the state of Jammu and Kashmir can now be understood and better accepted on the basis of these facts. It was to be complemented by the complacency of Indian politicians like Sardar Baldev Singh. It is only after the invasion had started in full swing that the import of Kalkat's warning was taken seriously